

ACADEMIC RESEARCH PROJECT (MBA-WILP)



**BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY & SCIENCE
PILANI (RAJASTHAN)**

PortIQ – AI-Powered Portfolio Intelligence

Executive Summary

MBACCZG583 – Management of AI Products

Submitted by:

Divya Pinto

BITS ID: 2024bc26588@wilp.bits-pilani.ac.in

Problem

Professional services organisations manage multiple client accounts, projects and delivery teams using disconnected project management, ERP, CRM, time-tracking and reporting systems. Portfolio managers spend significant time consolidating information before identifying commercial risks, declining margins, delivery issues and growth opportunities. Existing dashboards present historical information but still require manual interpretation, delaying decisions and increasing the effort required for executive reviews. The core business problem is not the lack of data but the lack of timely, evidence-based decision support that converts operational portfolio information into meaningful management actions.

Target User / Customer

The primary users are Portfolio Managers, Delivery Managers and PMO leaders responsible for monitoring portfolio performance across multiple client engagements. Secondary stakeholders include Business Unit Heads and executive leadership who require reliable portfolio insights for investment, pricing and delivery decisions. Typical questions include which accounts generate the highest margins, which projects require intervention, where utilisation can be improved and which customers deserve strategic investment.

Product Concept

PortIQ is an AI-powered portfolio decision intelligence platform that combines portfolio analytics with an evidence-grounded AI Copilot. The MVP includes an Executive Dashboard, Portfolio Analysis, Clients, Projects, Reports and the PortIQ Copilot. Users can analyse portfolio performance, compare accounts, identify loss-making projects, review profitability trends and ask business questions in natural language. Rather than replacing existing reporting tools, PortIQ provides an intelligent decision-support layer that transforms verified portfolio metrics into actionable management insights.

Why AI?

Traditional dashboards and rule-based reports provide visibility but cannot explain portfolio performance or answer contextual management questions. PortIQ uses AI because it enables users to interact with portfolio information conversationally while receiving explanations grounded in verified business metrics. Deterministic calculations first establish revenue, cost, utilisation and margin values. An AI orchestration layer retrieves the relevant portfolio context, constructs a structured prompt and supplies only validated information to the language model. This improves decision speed, reduces manual analysis effort and maintains transparency because recommendations remain evidence-based and subject to human judgement.

Recommendation

Recommendation: Pilot.

The prototype successfully validates the product concept, user workflow and AI interaction model. A controlled pilot should be conducted using live integrations with project management, ERP, CRM and time-tracking platforms. Success should be evaluated through reduced portfolio review effort, faster identification of commercial risks, improved visibility into profitability, increased user adoption and better executive decision support. If these objectives are achieved, the product can progress towards enterprise deployment with additional capabilities such as predictive analytics, live enterprise integrations and organisation-wide adoption.